The Morning Brief

MAY 30, 2026

Signoff Pending

S&P 500 books a ninth straight winning week and one of the strongest months on record as Dell's AI print and a 62.7 Chicago PMI surge close the chapter; Trump exits the Situation Room without a final determination on the 60-day Iran framework.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT (FRI CLOSE)	DELL (FRI)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	FEAR & GREED
7,580 · 9th straight wk ↑	$92.05 · Worst month since 3/20	~↑30% · Best day ever	~$73,400 · Range-bound	23 · Extreme Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review

MAY CLOSES AS ONE OF THE STRONGEST MONTHS ON RECORD — NINTH STRAIGHT WINNING WEEK FOR THE S&P, THE LONGEST STREAK SINCE 2023

Per TheStreet and Schwab coverage, the S&P 500 closed Friday at 7,580.08 (↑0.22%), the Dow at 51,032.46 (↑0.72%) for the first close above 51,000, and the Nasdaq at 26,972.62 (↑0.26%). Per the same reporting, May delivered approximately ↑5% on the S&P with comparable gains on the Nasdaq and Dow, and the index logged its ninth consecutive weekly gain — the longest such streak since late 2023. Friday's session was led by tech and financials on Dell's post-earnings move (approximately ↑30% intraday per CNBC, the company's best single session ever) and a residual bid from the Iran framework headlines. The Russell 2000 proxy IWM lagged at −0.55% per the data drop, consistent with the prior brief's observation that small-cap participation has remained narrow even as the headline indices have extended.

S&P 500 (FRI)	7,580.08 · ↑0.22% day · 9th straight winning week
DOW (FRI)	51,032 · ↑0.72% · First close above 51,000
NASDAQ (FRI)	26,972 · ↑0.26% · Strong May per TheStreet
RUSSELL 2000 (FRI)	IWM proxy $290.43 · ↓0.55% · Small-cap lag persists
DELL (FRI)	~↑30% intraday per CNBC · Best day ever
BRENT (FRI CLOSE)	$92.05 · ↓1.77% day · ~↓19% on month per CNBC
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY $645.80 support · Untouched on the week

CHICAGO PMI SURGED TO 62.7 — THE LARGEST SINGLE-MONTH JUMP SINCE THE 2020 PANDEMIC REBOUND, CUTTING AGAINST THE "HOT PCE FORCES A TIGHTER FED" NARRATIVE

Per the MNI release covered by Advisor Perspectives and Breitbart, the Chicago Business Barometer printed 62.7 in May against a 50.5 consensus and a 49.2 prior, the largest single-month jump since the 2020 pandemic rebound. The print follows Thursday's 3.8% headline PCE — the hottest reading in nearly three years per CNBC — and a 3.3% core in line with consensus per the BEA. The two data points together describe an economy reaccelerating into a still-elevated inflation regime, which historically tends to keep the Fed on hold rather than pulling cuts forward. The committee's dividend backbone (ADP, SYK, ABT, GPC, FAST) and AI infrastructure sleeve (LRCX, TSM, MRVL, CRDO, VST, NEE) both fit the regime: cash-generative defensives and secular growth that has historically been able to perform through tightening when end-demand is strong.

A month that prints approximately ↑5% on the S&P with comparable gains on the Nasdaq and Dow, anchored by the hottest Chicago PMI surge since the 2020 rebound, is a tape that has stopped fighting the inflation regime and started trading the growth one. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

Geopolitics

TRUMP EXITS A TWO-HOUR SITUATION ROOM MEETING WITHOUT A FINAL DETERMINATION ON THE 60-DAY IRAN FRAMEWORK — THE SIGNOFF REMAINS THE BINARY CATALYST INTO MONDAY'S OPEN

Per CNN and Washington Post live coverage, President Trump convened a Situation Room meeting Friday with Secretary Rubio and Vice President Vance to make what he described as a "final determination" on the proposed 60-day memorandum of understanding with Iran. The meeting concluded after roughly two hours with no decision announced. Per the New York Times reporting cited in the same coverage, no final determination has been made as of Friday evening. The framework as reported by Axios and CNN includes a 60-day extension of the current ceasefire, immediate reopening of the Strait of Hormuz to unrestricted vessel traffic, Iranian commitment to remove mines from the waterway within 30 days, and a progressive lifting of the US blockade of Iranian ports as transit is restored. Trump's public conditions per the same coverage include that Iran must agree never to acquire a nuclear weapon and that Hormuz must reopen immediately without tolls or restrictions on traffic. Iranian state media has stated the agreement has not been finalized. The weekend now functions as a binary catalyst: a Trump signoff before Asia opens Sunday evening would extend Friday's framework bid; a breakdown or another strike exchange would reverse Brent's month-long compression.

BRENT LOGGED ITS WORST MONTH SINCE MARCH 2020 — THE ENERGY SLEEVE IS NOW POSITIONED AGAINST AN EITHER/OR RATHER THAN A TAIL-RISK DISTRIBUTION

Per CNBC, Brent settled Friday at $92.05 (–1.77%) and closed the month down approximately 19%, the largest monthly decline since the March 2020 pandemic collapse. The move compresses the war-risk premium that had built across April and May while leaving the structurally rerouted Hormuz logistics in place per the prior brief's observation that supply chains, insurance markets, and corridor risk have been permanently re-priced. For the IOWN energy sleeve, the read into Monday is asymmetric: CVX, VLO, OKE, CNX, and CTRA were positioned for sustained supply disruption rather than for the deal-close compression that has now arrived; a confirmed signoff would extend the de-risking but the sleeve would still earn the structural cash flows underneath. A failed signoff or another strike exchange would re-introduce the war premium on a constrained base. Defense (LMT, GD) retains its orthogonal-hedge role through either path. Gold (GLD) closed Friday at $417.12 (↑1.05%) per the data drop but remains on track for a third consecutive monthly decline per Reuters — the cross-asset signal is that the dollar bid and the safe-haven bid have shared the framework-negotiation flow rather than one dominating cleanly.

TRUMP DECISION	Situation Room concluded ~2 hrs · No final determination per NYT
FRAMEWORK TERMS (AXIOS/CNN)	60-day extension · Hormuz immediate reopen · Mine removal in 30 days
TRUMP CONDITIONS	No Iranian nuclear weapon · Hormuz unrestricted, no tolls
IRANIAN POSTURE	State media: agreement not finalized
BRENT (MAY)	$92.05 Fri close · ~↓19% on month per CNBC · Worst since March 2020
GOLD (FRI)	GLD $417.12 ↑1.05% · Third straight monthly decline per Reuters

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — ISM Manufacturing Monday, ADP Wednesday, ISM Services Wednesday, and the May Employment Situation Friday June 5 anchor the next leg of the rate-path read. The Friday Chicago PMI surge to 62.7 (per MNI release) reset the growth read entering the week; an ISM Manufacturing print in expansionary territory Monday would extend the reacceleration narrative and reinforce the no-cuts base case into the June 16–17 FOMC. The employment report Friday is the higher-volatility catalyst — payrolls and average hourly earnings together will determine whether the "hot growth, hot inflation" combination is sustainable or whether a labor-market crack reintroduces the slowdown risk. For the dividend sleeve, a string of constructive prints historically tends to favor cash-generative names that compound through rate plateaus. *Avoid Erosion.*

2. CRDO reports fiscal Q4 after Monday's close (June 1) — the first IOWN-side test of whether the Dell-Snowflake AI capex confirmation translates into supplier-side fundamentals. Per Yahoo and Marketbeat coverage, consensus sits near $1.03 normalized EPS on roughly $430 million revenue against the company's prior $425–$435 million Q4 guide. The intra-week tape carried CRDO inside a roughly 7% intraday range Friday ($224.50–$240.81) before closing at $236.03 (↑6.15%) per the data drop, consistent with elevated option-implied volatility into Monday's print. A clean beat with a raised forward guide extends the leadership across MRVL, TEL, and the broader connectivity layer; a guide cut at the elevated multiple would produce an outsized reaction, consistent with the April pattern in ABT. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The AI capex confirmation set extended through the week — Dell finished the abbreviated week up approximately 40% per TheStreet, Snowflake also up approximately 40% on its $6 billion AWS commitment. Per CNBC reporting, Dell's fiscal Q1 print included a $51.3 billion AI server backlog, $24.4 billion in Q1 AI orders, and a raised FY27 AI revenue guide to $60 billion; the read-through across the IOWN AI infrastructure sleeve (LRCX, TSM, MRVL, CRDO, TEL, NEE, VST, HUT) is now broader than at any point this cycle. The committee's positioning around physical AI infrastructure has captured the leadership cleanly; the question into next week is whether the AI-led concentration broadens or narrows further on CRDO and June ISM data. **The physical world matters.**

4. Carson's active SPY $645.80 support remained untouched through the week as the index extended to fresh records. Friday's SPY intraday low printed $754.69 per the Saturday data drop — well above the level and consistent with the prior session's low of $749.23. The level remains the framework for any sustained downside scenario rather than an actionable near-term marker, particularly given the structural divergence between the record tape and the persistent Fear & Greed reading at 23 (Extreme Fear). Historically, when price and sentiment diverge at this magnitude into a binary geopolitical catalyst, the resolution tends to be sharp in whichever direction the catalyst breaks. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*